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The Editor-in-Chief
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Dear Editor-in-Chief,

We submit "Bounded-memory streaming redaction of personal data and credentials with a whole-document equivalence guarantee" for consideration as an original research article in the *International Journal of Information Security*.

Logs, database exports and packet captures must be stripped of personal data and credentials before they are shared, and they are routinely too large to process in one pass. Chunked processing introduces a silent leak: a secret that straddles a chunk boundary is missed and written out in the clear. We found no redaction, de-identification or secret-scanning system that states when its chunked output equals its whole-document output.

The paper closes that gap for context-dependent redaction. Each detector declares the longest span it emits and the context it reads; we show that an overlap as long as the longest span can still leak, and prove that an overlap covering every detector's span plus its right context makes streamed output equal to whole-document output, that the parallel engine is byte-identical to the sequential one or falls back to it, and that working memory is independent of input size. All proofs are in the paper (Section 5 and Appendix A); Online Resource 1 maps each step to the implementation and holds supplementary tables. The default overlap meets the requirement exactly. Measured memory stays between 8.4 and 8.54 MiB from 8 MiB to 2 GiB of input, against 904.6 MiB for whole-document redaction of a 32 MiB file.

We also measure the failure itself: on the test corpora, naive chunking leaked up to 237 values a whole-document pass redacts and overlapping windows still leaked some, while SafeStream matched the whole-document output under every chunking tried. On 2,000 real SSH log lines, frozen before scoring, every IP address was redacted but no system handled user names; an opt-in tier built from documented log formats then redacted all 618 user names in held-out real Linux logs. On real court judgments from the Text Anonymization Benchmark, Presidio initially detected more personal data than our named-entity configuration; we report that result in full, and show that a free-text configuration designed on the benchmark's development split and frozen before a single held-out run on 1,014 unseen judgments reaches character F1 0.67 against 0.54 for Presidio. We have tried to report the evaluation as a referee would want it. On 14,626 real credentials from 337 repositories (CredData), the pattern tiers fully redacted more values than gitleaks (0.55 against 0.40, robust to resampling by repository) at a higher false-alarm rate, which we report as a trade-off. Detection quality is measured on held-out splits against Presidio (three configurations), gitleaks and TruffleHog, with paired bootstrap intervals computed at the document level and, to account for dependence, with cluster and two-stage resampling by rule, template and domain. We re-ran both scanners with their false-positive filters disabled and report where margins do not survive that or clustering, the weak document-level protection on RedactionBench, and a contamination analysis that compares pre- and post-exposure code. Code, split manifests, raw results and per-document predictions are public.

The work fits the journal's scope in data protection, privacy-enhancing technologies and secure data handling, and should interest readers who build or deploy data-loss-prevention and secret-scanning pipelines.

The manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere, and all authors approve the submission. As stated in the manuscript, an AI assistant was used to implement evaluation scripts and to draft text; the authors reviewed every result and every sentence and take full responsibility for the content. The authors declare no competing interests.

Yours sincerely,

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